

State of the Web 2020–2025

HTTP Archive trends in page weight, protocols, and security

Time range: January 2020 through early 2026 • Desktop and mobile crawls measured separately

**Millio
ns**

URLs crawled at
scale

99%+

HTTPS request share

~40%

HTTP/3 support

12

Desktop TCP
connections

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



LATEST PLATEAU

16M desktop URLs

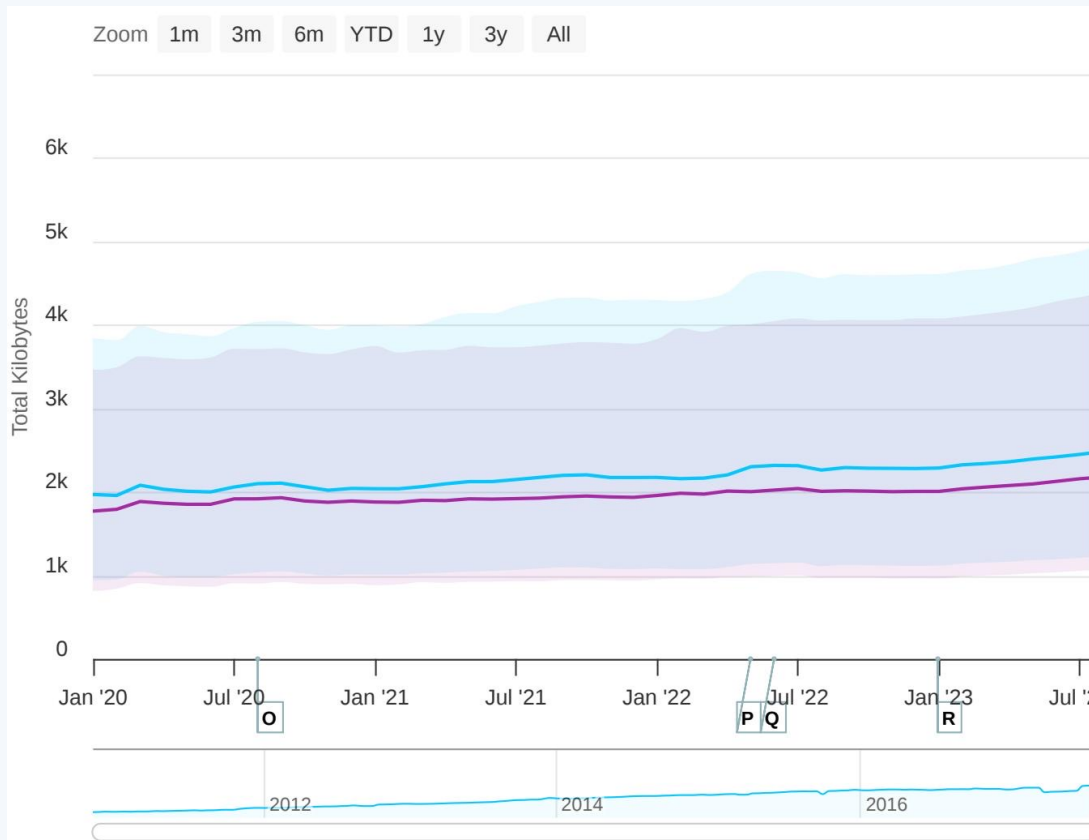
12.5M mobile URLs

Jan 2020 crawl: ~5M desktop and ~3.5M mobile URLs.

Mid-2022 jump: desktop ~15M and mobile ~10M.

Mid-2023 onward: stabilized near the current plateau.

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop



CURRENT MEDIANS

**~2,000
KB** desktop

**~1,900
KB** mobile

▲ ~25% both cohorts

The 75th-percentile desktop page exceeds 4,000 KB, showing a persistent long tail of heavy experiences.

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

MEDIAN RESOURCES REQUESTED

76

desktop requests

▲ 2.7%

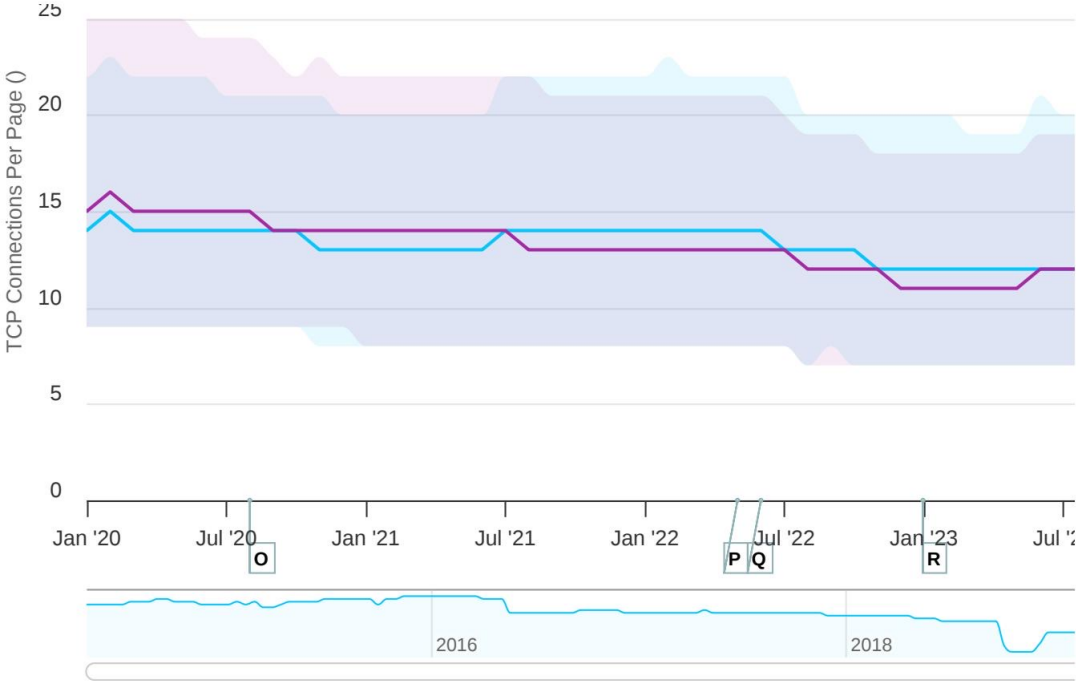
71

mobile requests

▲ 2.9%

Request counts rose slightly, but the connection footprint moved in the opposite direction.

TCP CONNECTIONS PER PAGE



Desktop: 15 → 12.0

Mobile: 15 → 11.0

Multiplexing cuts connections despite more resources.

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

99%+

HTTPS request share

99.2%

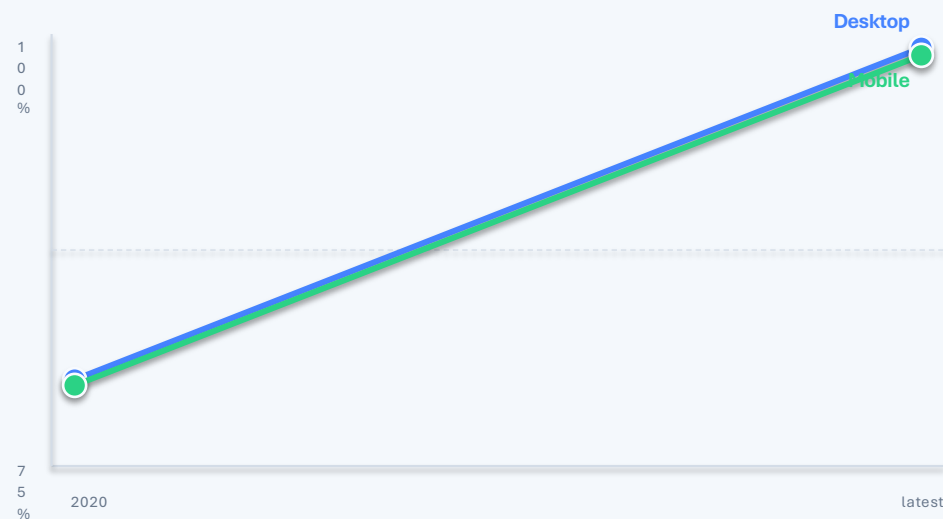
desktop

99.1%

mobile

Up roughly 19–20 percentage points since early 2020.

Small time-series: ~80% to 99%



Plaintext HTTP is effectively gone from modern request traffic.

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

LATEST SNAPSHOT

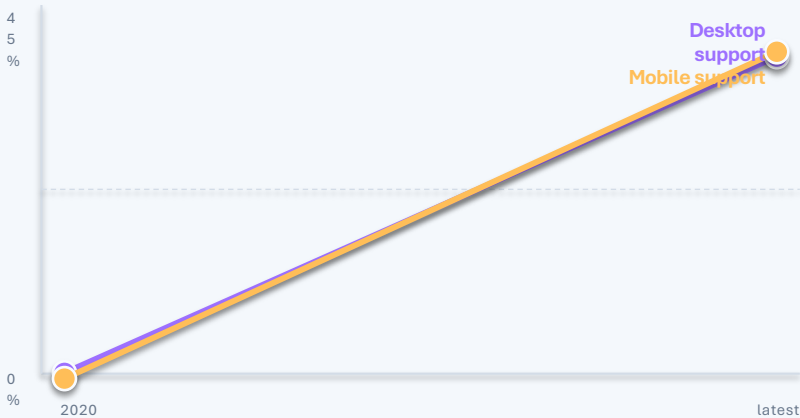
Request / support share by cohort



HTTP/2 growth is modest recently at 1–3%, while HTTP/3 absorbs newer protocol adoption.

HTTP/3 TRAJECTORY

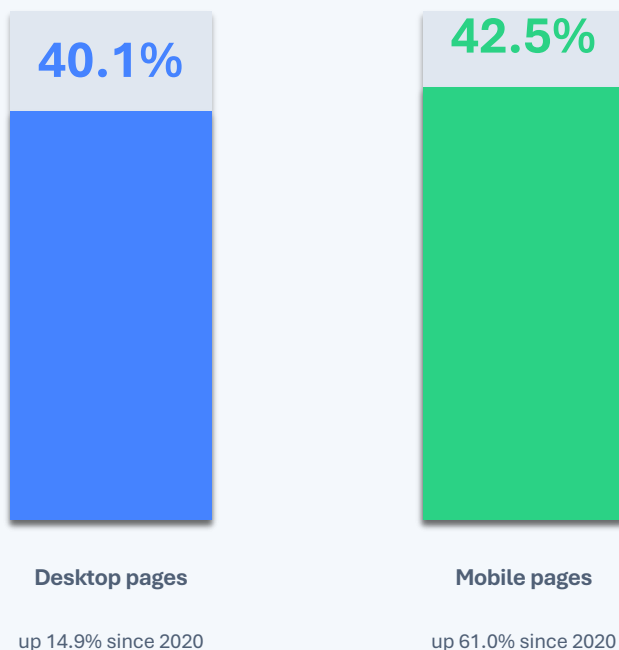
Near-zero baseline to ~40% support



Measurement caveat: HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support, not actual usage, because fresh Chrome instances first connect over HTTP/2 before discovering Alt-Svc capability.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

LATEST ADOPTION



WHY IT MATTERS

`font-display`` helps avoid FOIT during web font loading.

Measured by Lighthouse across desktop and mobile pages.

Adoption is rising, but more than half of pages still risk invisible text.

Use this as a typography performance baseline during audits.

Still below half of pages

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

-  **Page weight keeps climbing** Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than in 2020.
-  **HTTPS is the new baseline** 99%+ of requests use HTTPS; unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct.
-  **HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric** Support moved from near-zero to ~40% in under four years.
-  **Fewer TCP connections despite more requests** Median connections per page fell to 12 desktop and 11 mobile as multiplexing improved efficiency.
-  **Font-display remains an optimization gap** ~40–42% adoption leaves significant room to reduce invisible text.

Call to action: benchmark your own sites against these HTTP Archive baselines before prioritizing infrastructure and front-end optimization work.